

Haunted House

An Amstrad CPC (Locomotive BASIC) conversion by Claude (with minor patches by Brett Hallen, June 2026)

This is a conversion of the Haunted House adventure from Usborne's Write Your Own Adventure Programs for Your Microcomputer (the listing beginning on page 33). The book gives a generic "Microsoft BASIC" listing with conversion notes for the VIC-20, Oric, BBC, Spectrum and ZX81 — but not the Amstrad CPC. This version runs on a CPC 464, 664 or 6128 under Locomotive BASIC.

Line numbers are kept identical to the book so you can cross-reference the original. Only the lines listed below were changed; everything else is typed exactly as printed.

Loading and running

Type the listing in directly on a real machine or an emulator (WinAPE, Caprice32, RetroVirtualMachine all work well), then:

RUN

To keep a copy:

SAVE "HAUNTED"

In an emulator you can usually paste the .bas text straight into the BASIC editor, or convert it to a .DSK disk image with a tool such as iDSK / CPCDiskXP and then LOAD it.

Changes made for the Amstrad CPC

Line(s)	In the book	Amstrad CPC version	Reason
50	REM SELECT "TEXT MODE" IF NECESSARY	MODE 1:INK 0,0:INK 1,24:BORDER 0:PEN 1:PAPER 0	The CPC needs an explicit screen mode. MODE 1 gives a 40-column screen, wide enough for every message. The INK/BORDER/PAPER/PEN settings give bright text on a black background for atmosphere and are optional.
65	CLEAR 100	(line removed)	Marked "only needed on TRS-80." Locomotive BASIC's CLEAR takes no string-space argument, so this line would cause a syntax error. String space is handled automatically.
90	CLS	CLS (unchanged)	The CPC already has CLS, so the VIC-20 substitution (PRINT CHR\$(147)) is not needed.

420	...RND(3)<>3...	...INT(RND*3+1)<>3...	On the CPC, RND(x) for any positive x returns a fraction 0–1, so RND(3) never equals 3. Replaced with the integer form the book itself specifies for other machines (bats attack ~2 times in 3).
430	...RND(2)=1...	...INT(RND*2)=1...	Same RND issue. INT(RND*2) gives 0 or 1, a true 50/50 chance for the ghosts to appear.
1190	...RM=RND(63)	...RM=INT(RND*64)	Same RND issue. INT(RND*64) teleports you to a random room 0–63, as intended.
235	(new line)	Q\$=UPPER\$(Q\$)	Added so input is folded to upper case before parsing. The verb and object names are stored in capitals, so without this the player would have to use CAPS LOCK. UPPER\$ is built into Locomotive BASIC on all CPC models.

One small display tidy-up (not CPC-specific): line 150 originally printed a comma after every exit, leaving a trailing one — “EXITS: N,W,E,”. It now prints the comma only between exits, so the list reads “EXITS: N,W,E”.

Things that did NOT need changing

These are worth knowing, because the book’s notes for other machines can be misleading on the CPC:

Arrays start at zero. The listing fills R\$(0)...R\$(63) and D\$(0)...D\$(63) and depends on element zero existing. Locomotive BASIC arrays are 0-based by default, exactly like the Microsoft BASIC the listing targets, so the Spectrum’s “add 1 to every room index” rewrite is NOT needed here.

LET is optional. The Spectrum requires LET on every assignment; the CPC does not, so assignments are left bare as printed (e.g. V=25).

INPUT prompts. INPUT "...";Q\$ works as-is. The book notes a BBC may need a comma instead of the semicolon — the CPC is happy with the semicolon.

Ampersands in DATA. Room names such as “KITCHEN & GRIMY COOKER” and “STUDY WITH DESK & HOLE IN WALL” are left unquoted. When READ into a string variable, Locomotive BASIC takes the characters literally, so they don’t need quoting.

The long ON VB GOSUB at line 460 has 26 targets for 25 verbs — this is intentional, not a typo. An unrecognised verb sets VB to 26, which jumps to the bare RETURN at line 1590 and harmlessly does nothing.

Playing notes

Type your commands in either case — line 235 folds the input to upper case automatically (UPPER\$), so CAPS LOCK is not required. Most commands are two words, e.g. GET ROPE, OPEN DRAWER, LIGHT CANDLE, SAY XZANFAR. HELP lists the words it knows; CARRYING? lists your inventory; SCORE checks progress.

You start at the front gate (room 57) with a candle whose life (LL) is 60 turns; once lit it burns down and warns you before going out. Only N/S/W/E are processed directly — up and down work at the staircases, where lines 720–770 remap them.

Saving and quitting (pages 30–31)

Pages 30–31 of the book describe optional SAVE, LOAD and QUIT commands. These have been added and adapted to the CPC's file handling. Each is a single-word command — just type SAVE, LOAD or QUIT. (QUIT first asks whether you want to save, then ends the program.)

Three wiring changes connect the new commands, exactly as the book instructs:

- Line 70: V raised from 25 to 28 (three new verbs).
- Line 1665: SAVE, LOAD and QUIT appended to the verb list, becoming verbs 26, 27 and 28.
- Line 460: the subroutine numbers 3000, 4000 and 5000 spliced in just before the final 1590, so SAVE jumps to 3000, LOAD to 4000 and QUIT to 5000.

The new routines themselves (3000–3200 SAVE, 4000–4200 LOAD, 5000–5050 QUIT) needed the book's generic file commands swapped for real Locomotive BASIC ones:

Line(s)	In the book	Amstrad CPC version	Reason
3020 / 4020	OPEN FILE FOR OUTPUT / INPUT (placeholder)	OPENOUT"HOUSE" / OPENIN"HOUSE"	The book leaves these as plain-English placeholders to fill in per machine. On the CPC, OPENOUT opens a file to save to, OPENIN opens one to read back.
3030–3080 / 4030–4080	PRINT #1,... / INPUT #1,...	PRINT #9,... / INPUT #9,...	Locomotive BASIC uses stream #9 for the open cassette/disc file, not #1.
3080 / 4080	PRINT #1,C(I),F(I)	PRINT #9,C(I):PRINT #9,F(I)	Two values per line confuse INPUT# on the CPC. Writing (and reading) each on its own line makes the save reliable. The book's footnote flags this same separator problem for the BBC.

3100 / 4100	CLOSE	CLOSEOUT / CLOSEIN	The CPC closes the output and input files with separate keywords.
5020	INPUT "...",Q\$	INPUT "...";Q\$	Comma changed to semicolon for the CPC's INPUT prompt syntax.

Two things worth knowing. On a 464 the game saves to cassette and on a 664/6128 to disc; OPENOUT and OPENIN prompt you to ready the tape automatically, so the "READY TO SAVE/LOAD" questions are just polite extras. And, as the book itself warns, the save records only your room, the object positions, what you are carrying and the game flags — it does NOT save the D\$ and R\$ arrays. So any room you have permanently changed (opening the secret room, digging out the bars, unlocking the front door) reverts to its original description and exits when you reload. To preserve those too you would add matching loops for D\$ and R\$ to both routines.

Full listing

Filename: Haunted House (Amstrad CPC).bas

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10 REM HAUNTED HOUSE ADVENTURE
20 REM
30 REM AMSTRAD CPC (LOCOMOTIVE BASIC) VERSION
40 REM ADAPTED FROM USBORNE "WRITE YOUR OWN
45 REM ADVENTURE PROGRAMS", PAGE 33
50 MODE 1:INK 0,0:INK 1,24:BORDER 0:PEN 1:PAPER 0
60 REM
70 V=28:W=36:G=18
80 GOSUB 1600
90 CLS:PRINT"HAUNTED HOUSE"
100 PRINT"-----"
110 PRINT"YOUR LOCATION"
120 PRINT D$(RM)
130 PRINT"EXITS:"
140 FOR I=1 TO LEN(R$(RM))
150 PRINT MID$(R$(RM),I,1);:IF I<LEN(R$(RM)) THEN PRINT",";
160 NEXT I
170 PRINT
180 FOR I=1 TO G
190 IF L(I)=RM AND F(I)=0 THEN PRINT"YOU CAN SEE ";O$(I);" HERE"
200 NEXT I
210 PRINT"=====
220 PRINT M$:M$="WHAT"
230 INPUT"WHAT WILL YOU DO NOW";Q$
235 Q$=UPPER$(Q$)
240 V$="":W$="":VB=0:OB=0
250 FOR I=1 TO LEN(Q$)
260 IF MID$(Q$,I,1)=" " AND V$="" THEN V$=LEFT$(Q$,I-1)
270 IF MID$(Q$,I,1)=" " AND V$<>"" THEN W$=MID$(Q$,I+1,LEN(Q$)-1):I=LEN(Q$)
280 NEXT I
290 IF W$="" THEN V$=Q$
300 FOR I=1 TO V
310 IF V$=V$(I) THEN VB=I
320 NEXT I
330 FOR I=1 TO W
340 IF W$=O$(I) THEN OB=I
350 NEXT I
360 IF W$<>"" AND OB=0 THEN M$="THAT'S SILLY"
370 IF VB=0 THEN VB=V+1
380 IF W$="" THEN M$="I NEED TWO WORDS"
390 IF VB>V AND OB>0 THEN M$="YOU CAN'T '"+Q$+"'"
400 IF VB>V AND OB=0 THEN M$="YOU DON'T MAKE SENSE"
410 IF VB<V AND OB>0 AND C(OB)=0 THEN M$="YOU DON'T HAVE '"+W$
420 IF F(26)=1 AND RM=13 AND INT(RND*3+1)<>3 AND VB<>21 THEN M$="BATS ATTACKING!":GOTO 90
430 IF RM=44 AND INT(RND*2)=1 AND F(24)<>1 THEN F(27)=1
440 IF F(0)=1 THEN LL=LL-1
450 IF LL<1 THEN F(0)=0
460 ON VB GOSUB
500,570,640,640,640,640,640,640,980,980,1030,1070,1140,1180,1220,1250,1300,1340,1380,1400,1430,1460,1490,1510,30
00,4000,5000,1590
470 IF LL=10 THEN M$="YOUR CANDLE IS WANING!"
480 IF LL=1 THEN M$="YOUR CANDLE IS OUT!"
490 GOTO 90
500 PRINT"WORDS I KNOW:"
510 FOR I=1 TO V
520 PRINT V$(I);",";
530 NEXT I
540 M$="":PRINT
550 GOSUB 1580
560 RETURN
570 PRINT"YOU ARE CARRYING:"
580 FOR I=1 TO G
590 IF C(I)=1 THEN PRINT O$(I);",";
600 NEXT I
610 M$="":PRINT
620 GOSUB 1580
630 RETURN
640 D=0
650 IF OB=0 THEN D=VB-3
660 IF OB=19 THEN D=1
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670 IF OB=20 THEN D=2
680 IF OB=21 THEN D=3
690 IF OB=22 THEN D=4
700 IF OB=23 THEN D=5
710 IF OB=24 THEN D=6
720 IF RM=20 AND D=5 THEN D=1
730 IF RM=20 AND D=6 THEN D=3
740 IF RM=22 AND D=6 THEN D=2
750 IF RM=22 AND D=5 THEN D=3
760 IF RM=36 AND D=6 THEN D=2
770 IF RM=36 AND D=5 THEN D=2
780 IF F(14)=1 THEN M$="CRASH! YOU FELL OUT OF THE TREE!":F(14)=0:RETURN
790 IF F(27)=1 AND RM=52 THEN M$="GHOSTS WILL NOT LET YOU MOVE":RETURN
800 IF RM=45 AND C(1)=1 AND F(34)=0 THEN M$="A MAGICAL BARRIER TO THE WEST":RETURN
810 IF (RM=26 AND F(0)=0) AND (D=1 OR D=4) THEN M$="YOU NEED A LIGHT":RETURN
820 IF RM=54 AND C(15)<>1 THEN M$="YOU'RE STUCK!":RETURN
830 IF C(15)=1 AND NOT (RM=53 OR RM=54 OR RM=55 OR RM=47) THEN M$="YOU CAN'T CARRY A BOAT!":RETURN
840 IF (RM>26 AND RM<30) AND F(0)=0 THEN M$="TOO DARK TO MOVE":RETURN
850 F(35)=0:RL=LEN(R$(RM))
860 FOR I=1 TO RL
870 U$=MID$(R$(RM),I,1)
880 IF (U$="N" AND D=1 AND F(35)=0) THEN RM=RM-8:F(35)=1
890 IF (U$="S" AND D=2 AND F(35)=0) THEN RM=RM+8:F(35)=1
900 IF (U$="W" AND D=3 AND F(35)=0) THEN RM=RM-1:F(35)=1
910 IF (U$="E" AND D=4 AND F(35)=0) THEN RM=RM+1:F(35)=1
920 NEXT I
930 M$="OK"
940 IF F(35)=0 THEN M$="CAN'T GO THAT WAY!"
950 IF D<1 THEN M$="GO WHERE?"
960 IF RM=41 AND F(23)=1 THEN R$(49)="SW":M$="THE DOOR SLAMS SHUT!":F(23)=0
970 RETURN
980 IF OB>G THEN M$="I CAN'T GET "+W$:RETURN
985 IF L(OB)<>RM THEN M$="IT ISN'T HERE"
990 IF F(OB)<>0 THEN M$="WHAT "+W$+"?"
1000 IF C(OB)=1 THEN M$="YOU ALREADY HAVE IT"
1010 IF OB>0 AND L(OB)=RM AND F(OB)=0 THEN C(OB)=1:L(OB)=65:M$="YOU HAVE THE "+W$
1020 RETURN
1030 IF RM=43 AND (OB=28 OR OB=29) THEN F(17)=0:M$="DRAWER OPEN"
1040 IF RM=28 AND OB=25 THEN M$="IT'S LOCKED"
1050 IF RM=38 AND OB=32 THEN M$="THAT'S CREEPY!":F(2)=0
1060 RETURN
1070 IF OB=30 THEN F(18)=0:M$="SOMETHING HERE!"
1080 IF OB=31 THEN M$="THAT'S DISGUSTING!"
1090 IF (OB=28 OR OB=29) THEN M$="THERE IS A DRAWER"
1100 IF OB=33 OR OB=5 THEN GOSUB 1140
1110 IF RM=43 AND OB=35 THEN M$="THERE IS SOMETHING BEYOND.."
1120 IF OB=32 THEN GOSUB 1030
1130 RETURN
1140 IF RM=42 AND OB=33 THEN M$="THEY ARE DEMONIC WORKS"
1150 IF (OB=3 OR OB=36) AND C(3)=1 AND F(34)=0 THEN M$="USE THIS WORD WITH CARE 'XZANFAR'"
1160 IF C(5)=1 AND OB=5 THEN M$="THE SCRIPT IS IN AN ALIEN TONGUE"
1170 RETURN
1180 M$="OK ""+W$+"""
1190 IF C(3)=1 AND OB=34 THEN M$="*MAGIC OCCURS*":IF RM<>45 THEN RM=INT(RND*64)
1200 IF C(3)=1 AND OB=34 AND RM=45 THEN F(34)=1
1210 RETURN
1220 IF C(12)=1 THEN M$="YOU MADE A HOLE"
1230 IF C(12)=1 AND RM=30 THEN M$="DUG THE BARS OUT":D$(RM)="HOLE IN WALL":R$(RM)="NSE"
1240 RETURN
1250 IF C(14)<>1 AND RM=7 THEN M$="THIS IS NO TIME TO PLAY GAMES"
1260 IF OB=14 AND C(14)=1 THEN M$="YOU SWUNG IT"
1270 IF OB=13 AND C(13)=1 THEN M$="WHOOSH!"
1280 IF OB=13 AND C(13)=1 AND RM=43 THEN R$(RM)="WN":D$(RM)="STUDY WITH SECRET ROOM":M$="YOU BROKE THE THIN WALL"
1290 RETURN
1300 IF OB=14 AND C(14)=1 THEN M$="IT ISN'T ATTACHED TO ANYTHING!"
1310 IF OB=14 AND C(14)<>1 AND RM=7 AND F(14)=0 THEN M$="YOU SEE THICK FOREST AND CLIFF SOUTH":F(14)=1:RETURN
1320 IF OB=14 AND C(14)<>1 AND RM=7 AND F(14)=1 THEN M$="GOING DOWN!":F(14)=0
1330 RETURN
1340 IF OB=17 AND C(17)=1 AND C(8)=0 THEN M$="IT WILL BURN YOUR HANDS"
1350 IF OB=17 AND C(17)=1 AND C(9)=0 THEN M$="NOTHING TO LIGHT IT WITH"
1360 IF OB=17 AND C(17)=1 AND C(9)=1 AND C(8)=1 THEN M$="IT CASTS A FLICKERING LIGHT":F(0)=1
1370 RETURN
1380 IF F(0)=1 THEN F(0)=0:M$="EXTINGUISHED"
1390 RETURN
1400 IF OB=26 AND C(16)=1 THEN M$="HISSSS"

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1410 IF OB=26 AND C(16)=1 AND F(26)=1 THEN F(26)=0:M$="PFFT! GOT THEM"
1420 RETURN
1430 IF OB=10 AND C(10)=1 AND C(11)=1 THEN M$="SWITCHED ON":F(24)=1
1440 IF F(27)=1 AND F(24)=1 THEN M$="WHIZZ- VACUUMED THE GHOSTS UP!":F(27)=0
1450 RETURN
1460 IF RM=43 AND (OB=27 OR OB=28) THEN GOSUB 1030
1470 IF RM=28 AND OB=25 AND F(25)=0 AND C(18)=1 THEN F(25)=1:R$(RM)="SEW":D$(RM)="HUGE OPEN DOOR":M$="THE KEY
TURNS!"
1480 RETURN
1490 IF C(OB)=1 THEN C(OB)=0:L(OB)=RM:M$="DONE"
1500 RETURN
1510 S=0
1520 FOR I=1 TO G
1530 IF C(I)=1 THEN S=S+1
1540 NEXT I
1550 IF S=17 AND C(15)<>1 AND RM<>57 THEN PRINT"YOU HAVE EVERYTHING":PRINT"RETURN TO THE GATE FOR FINAL SCORE"
1560 IF S=17 AND RM=57 THEN PRINT"DOUBLE SCORE FOR REACHING HERE!":S=S*2
1570 PRINT"YOUR SCORE=";S:IF S>18 THEN PRINT"WELL DONE! YOU FINISHED THE GAME":END
1580 INPUT"PRESS RETURN TO CONTINUE";Q$
1590 RETURN
1600 DIM R$(63),D$(63),O$(W),V$(V)
1610 DIM C(W),L(G),F(W)
1620 DATA 46,38,35,50,13,18,28,42,10,25,26,4,2,7,47,60,43,32
1630 FOR I=1 TO G
1640 READ L(I)
1650 NEXT I
1660 DATA HELP,CARRYING?,GO,N,S,W,E,U,D,GET,TAKE,OPEN,EXAMINE,READ,SAY
1665 DATA DIG,SWING,CLIMB,LIGHT,UNLIGHT,SPRAY,USE,UNLOCK,LEAVE,SCORE,SAVE,LOAD,QUIT
1680 FOR I=1 TO V
1690 READ V$(I)
1700 NEXT I
1710 DATA SE,WE,WE,SWE,WE,WE,SWE,WS
1720 DATA NS,SE,WE,NW,SE,W,NE,NSW
1730 DATA NS,NS,SE,WE,NWUD,SE,WSUD,NS
1740 DATA N,NS,NSE,WE,WE,NSW,NS,NS
1750 DATA S,NSE,NSW,S,NSUD,N,N,NS
1760 DATA NE,NW,NE,W,NSE,WE,W,NS
1770 DATA SE,NSW,E,WE,NS,S,SW,NW
1780 DATA NWE,NWE,WE,WE,WE,NWE,NWE,W
1790 FOR I=0 TO 63
1800 READ R$(I)
1810 NEXT I
1820 DATA DARK CORNER,OVERGROWN GARDEN,BY LARGE WOODPILE,YARD BY RUBBISH
1825 DATA WEEDPATCH,FOREST,THICK FOREST,BLASTED TREE
1840 DATA CORNER OF HOUSE,ENTRANCE TO KITCHEN,KITCHEN & GRIMY COOKER,SCULLERY DOOR
1845 DATA ROOM WITH INCHES OF DUST,REAR TURRET ROOM,CLEARING BY HOUSE,PATH
1860 DATA SIDE OF HOUSE,BACK OF HALLWAY,DARK ALCOVE,SMALL DARK ROOM
1865 DATA BOTTOM OF SPIRAL STAIRCASE,WIDE PASSAGE,SLIPPERY STEPS,CLIFFTOP
1880 DATA NEAR CRUMBLING WALL,GLOOMY PASSAGE,POOL OF LIGHT,IMPRESSIVE VAULTED HALLWAY
1885 DATA HALL BY THICK WOODEN DOOR,TROPHY ROOM,CELLAR WITH BARRED WINDOW,CLIFF PATH
1900 DATA CUPBOARD WITH HANGING COAT,FRONT HALL,SITTING ROOM,SECRET ROOM
1905 DATA STEEP MARBLE STAIRS,DINING ROOM,DEEP CELLAR WITH COFFIN,CLIFF PATH
1920 DATA CLOSET,FRONT LOBBY,LIBRARY OF EVIL BOOKS,STUDY WITH DESK & HOLE IN WALL
1925 DATA WEIRD COBWEBBY ROOM,VERY COLD CHAMBER,SPOOKY ROOM,CLIFF PATH BY MARSH
1940 DATA RUBBLE-STREWN VERANDAH,FRONT PORCH,FRONT TOWER,SLOPING CORRIDOR
1945 DATA UPPER GALLERY,MARSH BY WALL,MARSH,SOGGY PATH
1960 DATA BY TWISTED RAILING,PATH THROUGH IRON GATE,BY RAILINGS,BENEATH FRONT TOWER
1965 DATA DEBRIS FROM CRUMBLING FACADE,LARGE FALLEN BRICKWORK,ROTTING STONE ARCH,CRUMBLING CLIFFTOP
1980 FOR I=0 TO 63
1990 READ D$(I)
2000 NEXT I
2010 DATA PAINTING,RING,MAGIC SPELLS,GOBLET,SCROLL,COINS,STATUE,CANDLESTICK
2012 DATA MATCHES,VACUUM,BATTERIES,SHOVEL,AXE,ROPE,BOAT,AEROSOL,CANDLE,KEY
2014 DATA NORTH,SOUTH,WEST,EAST,UP,DOWN
2016 DATA DOOR,BATS,GHOSTS,DRAWER,DESK,COAT,RUBBISH
2018 DATA COFFIN,BOOKS,XZANFAR,WALL,SPELLS
2060 FOR I=1 TO W
2070 READ O$(I)
2080 NEXT I
2090 F(18)=1:F(17)=1:F(2)=1:F(26)=1:F(28)=1:F(23)=1:LL=60:RM=57:M$="OK"
2100 RETURN
3000 INPUT"READY TO SAVE";Y$
3010 IF Y$<>"Y" THEN 3000
3020 OPENOUT"HOUSE"
3030 PRINT #9,RM

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3040 FOR I=1 TO G
3050 PRINT #9,L(I)
3060 NEXT I
3070 FOR I=1 TO W
3080 PRINT #9,C(I):PRINT #9,F(I)
3090 NEXT I
3100 CLOSEOUT
3200 RETURN
4000 INPUT"READY TO LOAD";Y$
4010 IF Y$<>"Y" THEN 4000
4020 OPENIN"HOUSE"
4030 INPUT #9,RM
4040 FOR I=1 TO G
4050 INPUT #9,L(I)
4060 NEXT I
4070 FOR I=1 TO W
4080 INPUT #9,C(I):INPUT #9,F(I)
4090 NEXT I
4100 CLOSEIN
4200 RETURN
5000 INPUT"WANT TO QUIT";Q$
5010 IF Q$<>"Y" THEN RETURN
5020 INPUT"LIKE TO SAVE GAME FIRST";Q$
5030 IF Q$="Y" THEN GOSUB 3000
5040 PRINT"THANKS FOR PLAYING"
5050 END
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